ARTO METRICS



ZINE NO. 1 · NUMBERS ARE A FORM OF GOSSIP

- PADRES — Record Sale, Zero Championships
- ANIME — Source Sets the Audience Floor
- FRANCHISE — Merchandise Owns the Ledger
- READMITTED — The 3% Stick Medicare Keeps Swinging

WHAT'S INSIDE

P.3 PADRES
Record Sale, Zero Championships
San Diego solved demand and the tax bill. It has not solved October. Franchise values follow the market and the ballpark anyway.

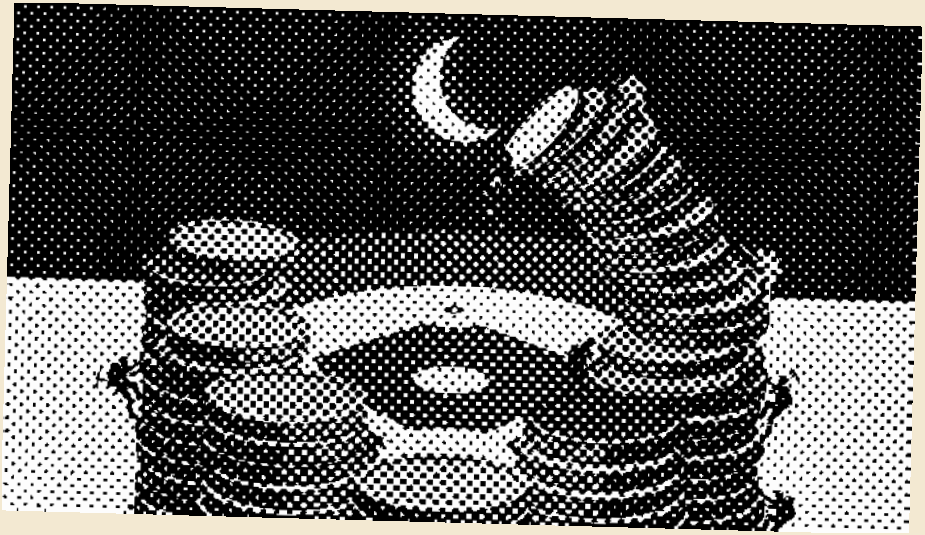
P.5 ANIME
Source Sets the Audience Floor
In a century of MyAnimeList data, light-novel TV adaptations draw 32 times the median audience of original series. The data also shows where fan ratings and commercial value part ways.

P.7 FRANCHISE
Merchandise Owns the Ledger
One hundred three Wikipedia-scraped franchises (mid-2019) sum to $1.52T lifetime revenue. Merchandise is 56% of row totals; Pokémon leads at $90.9B. By region of origin: Japan $681.5B, the US $622.6B (45 franchises, 64.6% merchandise), the UK $163.4B.

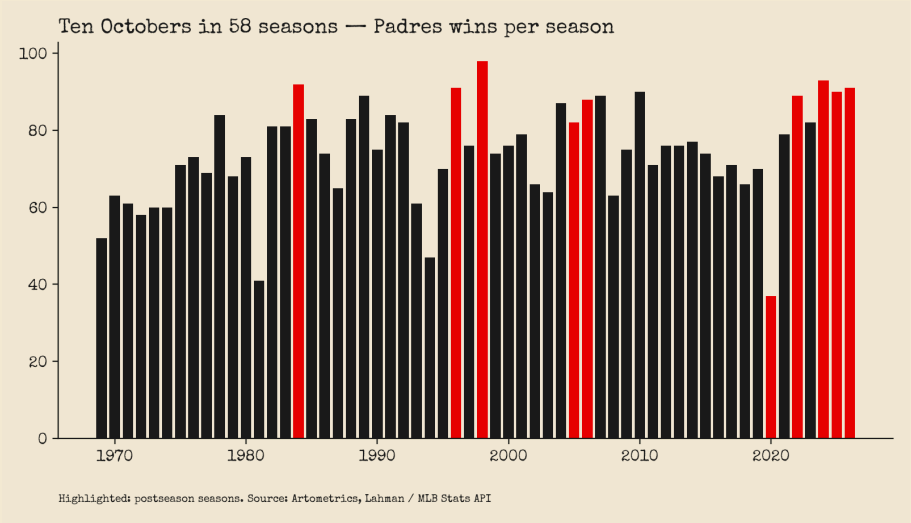
P.9 READMITTED
The 3% Stick Medicare Keeps Swinging
In CMS's latest Hospital Readmissions Reduction Program extract, 48.15% of hospital-condition pairs still exceed the expected readmission ratio after a decade of penalties capped at 3% of Medicare payments. This R2 report maps HRRP history, who pays, safety-net effects, observation and mortality debates, international comparators, and eight charts for hospital executives.

PADRES

Record Sale, Zero Championships



San Diego solved the two problems a mid-market club is supposed to fail. The park is full. The tax bill is paid. October is still close to a coin flip, and the franchise is on the wrong side of it. The market is paying a record price anyway. Franchise values follow the city and the building, not the trophy case. Executive summary Five findings, for an owner, a lender, or the league office.…

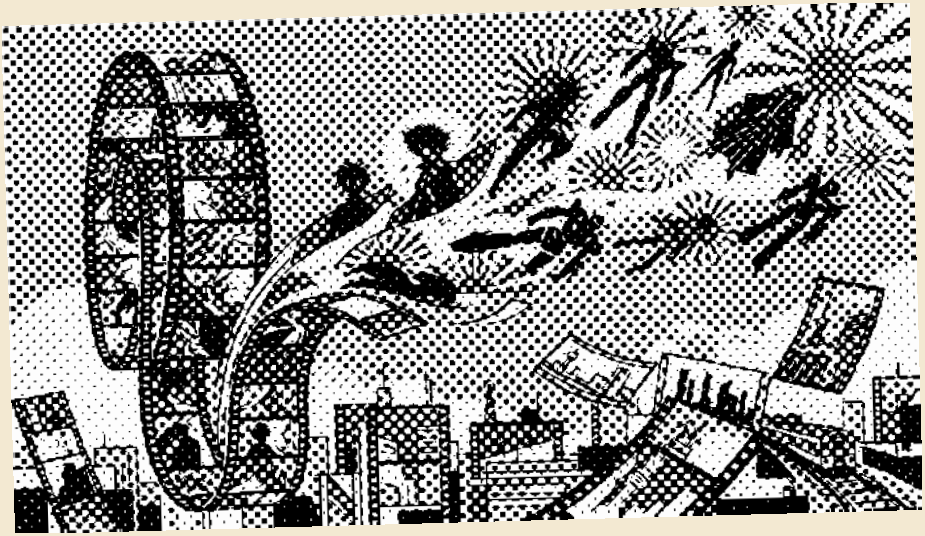


“On August 17, 2026, Major League Baseball owners unanimously approved the transfer to José E.”

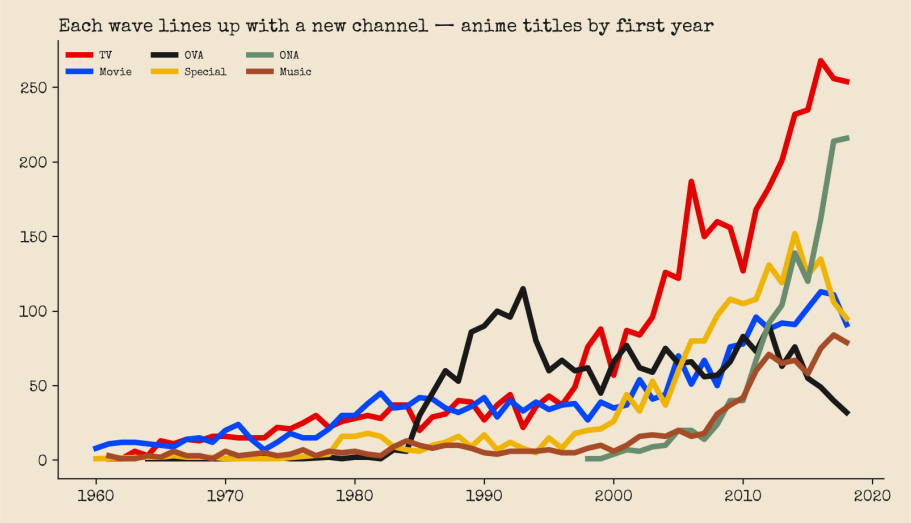
The vote is in. On August 17, 2026, Major League Baseball owners unanimously approved the transfer to José E. Feliciano and Kwanza Jones. Feliciano is the control person. Erik Greupner stays as chief executive. A.J. Preller stays in baseball operations. Associated Press and NBC 7 San Diego both reported the agreed price at $3.9 billion, an MLB record. Demand is not the missing piece. In the Lahman file the club drew 3,437,201 in 2025, second in the majors, behind the Dodgers at 4,012,470. In 2026 Baseball-Reference records 3,347,081, second in the National League. Petco's first full era, 2004-19, averaged 2,372,417. The eight seasons before it, 1996-2003, averaged 2,292,236. October is a habit now, and still not a pennant. Ten postseasons in 58 seasons. Two pennants, 1984 and 1998. The series…

ANIME

Source Sets the Audience Floor



Death Note has 1,610,561 MyAnimeList members, more than any other anime in the archive, and scores 8.66. Hanada Shounen-shi, a 2002 series from the same studio, Madhouse, scores 8.11 and has 8,929. A MyAnimeList archive of 13,631 titles, from 1917 to an early-2019 snapshot, suggests that much of a gap like that is set before anyone draws a frame, starting with where the story comes from. On television, light-novel adaptations draw a median of 153,184 platform members. Manga adaptations draw 37,500 and original series 4,738, which puts light novels about 32 times ahead of originals. Quality follows a different pattern. Only 4.6% of original TV series and 0.5% of TV game adaptations score 8.0 or higher as of the early-2019…

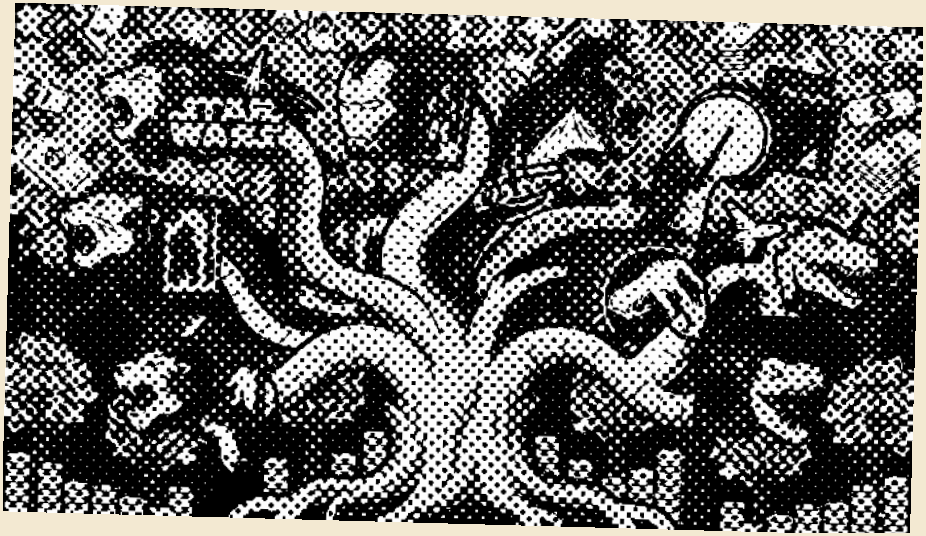


> "It's a series of format waves, and each wave lines up with a new channel."

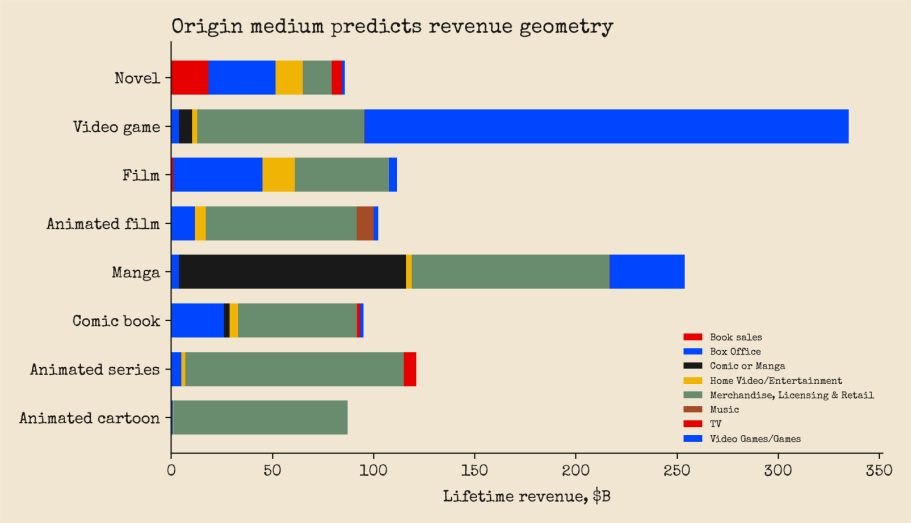
RESEARCH QUESTION Which decisions made before production (format, source material, studio, and whether to make a sequel) are associated with a title's reach and fan rating, and where does the platform's popularity record miss strong work?…

FRANCHISE

Merchandise Owns the Ledger



Executive summary. Franchise economics is licensing geometry: who owns repeatable rights, and which revenue streams compound after the premiere. In the mid-2019 Wikipedia/TidyTuesday ledger (103 properties, $1,522.2B row-sum lifetime revenue, S001), merchandise-weighted rows beat theatrical for most names; box office is 8.9% of the file. Pokémon leads at $90.9B because games, cards, and retail compound — not because it beats every stacked Marvel and Star Wars row you could add. Japan's media-mix and production-committee history explain why animation often functions as a storefront for objects; Hollywood's answer is studio-owned IP wired to parks and retail — The Walt Disney Company's consolidated franchise rows sum to $426.2B while FY2024 Experiences segment revenue alone is $34.2B (10-K, S081). The domestic top ten…

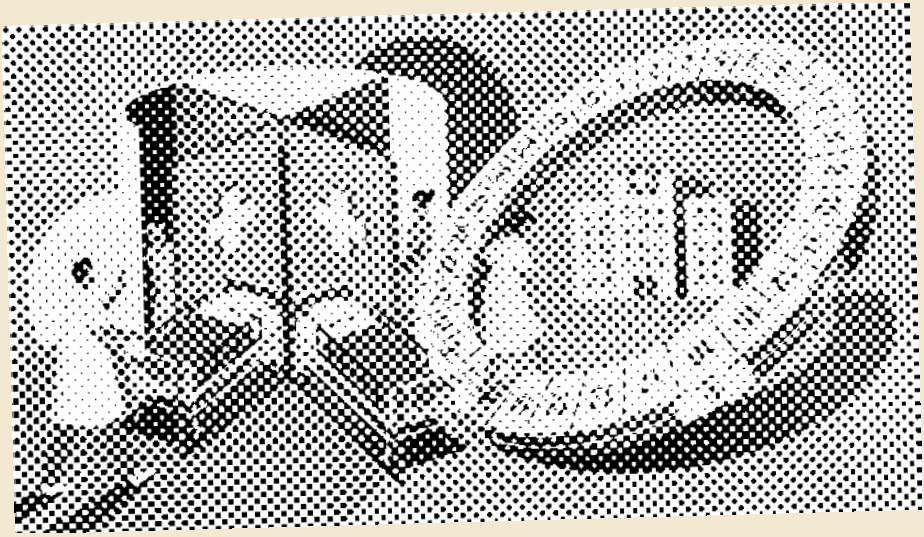


> “Both trades assume the same premise — that characters can be mined long after opening weekend.”

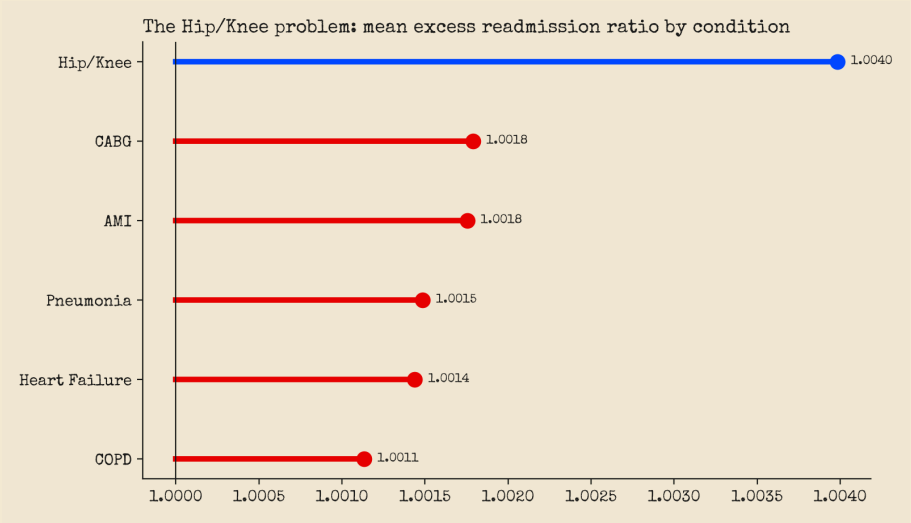
ONE LEDGER, TWO PLAYGROUNDS A child trades a cardboard Pikachu for lunch money; Bob Iger signs a seventy-one-point-three-billion-dollar check for Twenty-First Century Fox. Both trades assume the same premise — that characters can be mined long after opening weekend. The TidyTuesday file published July 2, 2019 is our x-ray: 103 media franchises scraped from Wikipedia’s “highest-grossing media franchises” list, each split across up to eight revenue streams (merchandise, box office, games, comics, and others). Figures are lifetime estimates through roughly mid-2019, not audited studio financials. They are still the cleanest public ledger for comparing how money attaches to IP — verified against franchise.csv (SHA-256 logged in verified_numbers.csv, source S001). This report reads that ledger the way an anime R2 report reads MyAnimeList: as the footprint of a production system, not…

READMITTED

The 3% Stick Medicare Keeps Swinging



In 2009, Jencks and colleagues reported that nearly one in five Medicare fee-for-service patients returned to the hospital within thirty days. Congress answered with the Hospital Readmissions Reduction Program (HRRP): starting in October 2012, CMS began shaving inpatient prospective payment system (IPPS) dollars when risk-standardized thirty-day readmissions exceeded targets for six conditions. The maximum cut rose from 1% in fiscal year 2013 to 3% in FY2015, and it applies to all Medicare DRG payments—not just the condition that missed (CMS, QualityNet; MedPAC, 2024). The October 2026 CMS supplemental extract (dataset 9n3s-kdb3, measurement window July 1, 2021–June 30, 2024) still flags 48.15% of hospital-condition pairs above an excess readmission ratio (ERR) of 1.0. ERR divides predicted readmissions by expected readmissions for…



> “Penalty-timeline points for FY2025-FY2026 come from Advisory Board analyses of CMS preliminary payment-reduction files; 2012-2015 national rates follow Zuckerman et al.”

RESEARCH QUESTION After fourteen years of HRRP, where do penalties still concentrate in the latest CMS file—by state, condition, ownership, and safety-net proxy—and what should hospital executives infer about transitional care, observation-status gaming, mortality tradeoffs, and CMS’s shift toward episode-based models such as TEAM?…